

Nicole Semenza, LSW

Cinnaminson, NJ

Camden / Philadelphia Region

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Policy, research, and advocacy professional with 8+ years of experience advancing legislative priorities, managing stakeholder engagement, translating research into policy action, and developing public-facing advocacy materials across health and social-impact issues. Background includes policy research, legislative affairs, coalition support, policy communications, and cross-sector relationship management with legislators, staff, agencies, and community partners. Strong writer and analyst experienced in policy briefs, reports, presentations, action alerts, and stakeholder-facing materials. South Jersey-based candidate available for hybrid work in Camden.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- Policy research and analysis
- Program and project coordination
- Healthcare and Medicaid policy
- Public policy communications
- Presentations and meeting coordination
- Cross-sector collaboration
- State and federal advocacy
- Coalition and stakeholder engagement
- Behavioral health and prevention policy
- Policy briefs, memos, and reports
- Legislative outreach and relationship-building
- Microsoft Office and Excel

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Policy Research Associate, Prenatal-to-Three Policy Impact Center The LBJ School of Public Affairs, University of Texas at Austin

Austin, TX | October 2020-March 2022

- Conducted policy research and technical evidence reviews on Medicaid expansion, group prenatal care, doula services, and child screening programs, translating complex findings for agencies and policymakers considering funding and program improvements.
- Served as the women's and children's health policy subject-matter contributor, supporting evidence-based policy development and cross-team dissemination.
- Co-authored annual reports and collaborated across the research center to share policy analysis with partner and public-sector audiences.

Director, Legislative Affairs and Advocacy Venture Global Consulting

Alexandria, VA / Austin, TX | August 2018-September 2020

- Advanced client policy priorities through direct engagement with legislators, legislative staff, and external stakeholders focused on substance use prevention funding and public policy strategy.
- Coordinated stakeholder outreach and relationship-building to strengthen support for advocacy goals across partners with varied perspectives.
- Developed public-facing advocacy materials, including op-eds, letters of support, and reports, to support legislative strategy and policy education.

Public Policy Manager; Public Policy Associate Community Anti-Drug Coalitions of America (CADCA)

Alexandria, VA | June 2017-August 2018

- Managed bipartisan stakeholder engagement across congressional chambers to build support for national substance use prevention initiatives.
- Developed advocacy toolkits and legislative alerts used by 5,000+ coalition members, helping local coalitions engage lawmakers across congressional districts.
- Prepared reports, presentations, and publications highlighting program results for policymakers, partners, and member audiences.
- Supported coalition-based advocacy efforts by coordinating materials, stakeholder communication, and follow-up across multiple partners.

Professional Experience Continued

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE CONTINUED

Legislative Fellow

Washington, DC | January 2017-June 2017

Women's Congressional Policy Institute

- Managed the health policy portfolio for Congresswoman Roybal-Allard, coordinating stakeholder meetings and policy input to inform legislative priorities.
- Served as congressional lead for the Women's Working Group on Immigration, partnering with public and private stakeholders to advance policy initiatives.
- Worked in a fast-moving legislative environment that required clear communication, issue synthesis, and coordination across internal and external stakeholders.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

Full-Time Parent

Cinnaminson, NJ | March 2022-Present

Career chapter focused on full-time caregiving and family leadership responsibilities while remaining committed to long-term work in policy and advocacy.

Research Associate

Hartford, CT | December 2015-April 2017

UConn Rudd Center for Food Policy and Obesity

- Conducted content analysis for the FACTS 2017 report on food advertising targeting parents.
- Managed participant recruitment and engagement for public health research studies.

Volunteer in Service to America (VISTA)

West Haven, CT | August 2012-August 2013

AmeriCorps, University of New Haven

- Managed the Community Work-Study program, increasing student participation by 40% through targeted outreach and collaboration.
- Conducted site visits and built relationships with local nonprofit partners to strengthen university-community engagement.

EDUCATION

University of Connecticut School of Social Work

Master of Social Work (MSW), Policy Practice Concentration

Women, Children, and Families Specialization | Urban Service Track / Area Health Education Center Scholar

University of Connecticut

Bachelor of Arts (BA), Psychology | Minor in Criminal Justice